

PART A

Employability Skills

Five foundational units covering workplace readiness, digital literacy, and life skills. All units are Level II continuations from Class IX.

50
TOTAL HOURS

10
TOTAL MARKS

2
MARKS / UNIT

UNIT 1

Communication Skills - II

- Reading comprehension
- Formal writing (emails, reports)
- Verbal & non-verbal skills
- Active listening
- Public speaking basics

10 hrs

2 marks

UNIT 2

Self-Management Skills - II

- Stress & emotion management
- Goal setting & time mgmt
- Self-motivation & attitude
- Adaptability & resilience
- Growth mindset

10 hrs

2 marks

UNIT 3

ICT Skills - II

- Advanced word processing
- Presentations & spreadsheets
- Internet safety & etiquette
- Cloud & collaboration tools
- Cybersecurity awareness

10 hrs

2 marks

UNIT 4

Entrepreneurial Skills - II

- Entrepreneurship concepts
- Identifying opportunities
- Business planning & budget
- Risk-taking & decisions
- Social entrepreneurship

10 hrs

2 marks

UNIT 6

Green Skills - II

- Sustainable Dev Goals (SDGs)
- Waste mgmt & circular economy
- Renewable energy sources
- Carbon footprint & climate
- Green careers & practices

10 hrs

2 marks



5 Units

EQUAL WEIGHTAGE • 2 MARKS EACH



50 Hours

10 HRS PER UNIT • THEORY FOCUS



10 Marks

OUT OF 100 TOTAL • EASY SCORING

Unit 1: Communication Fundamentals

Topic 1: Reading Comprehension

Goal: Moving beyond "word recognition" to deep understanding.

Reading comprehension is a complex cognitive process. It's not just about saying the words; it's about **processing text, understanding its meaning**, and, most importantly, **integrating it with what you already know**. If you don't connect new info to old info, you won't remember it.

The Techniques:

1. Skimming (The Bird's Eye View):

- **Definition:** Running your eyes very rapidly over large chunks of text. You are *intentionally* ignoring details to find the "gist" or the main idea (the thesis).
- **How:** Read the title, the introduction, the first sentence of every paragraph (the topic sentences), and the conclusion.
- **Detailed Example:** You have 15 minutes to research "The Causes of World War I." You pick up a massive biography of **Archduke Franz Ferdinand**. You *skim* the introduction and conclusion chapters only. In 5 minutes, you have a high-level overview (the "big picture") of why he was important, without reading all 800 pages about his childhood.

Scanning (The Laser Beam):

- **Definition:** Sweeping your eyes across the text looking for *one specific marker* (a keyword, a number, a name, or a date). You are not reading for meaning; you are searching for a target.
- **How:** Keep the specific word or number "in your mind's eye" and let your eyes drift until they lock onto it.
- **Detailed Example:** You are looking at a crowded city bus schedule (Image below). You don't read every stop or every time. You are only looking for "**Route 42**" and "**PM.**" Your eyes 'jump' past everything else.

2. Active Reading (The "Engagement"):

- **Definition:** Making reading a physical activity. You must *force* your brain to stay awake and engage with the material.
- **How:** Use a pen or highlighter. *Do not just highlight everything.* Highlight *only* key terms, unique definitions, and dates. Write questions in the margins ("Wait, why?") or connection notes ("This is just like the French Revolution!").

3. Context Clues (The Detective Work):

- **Definition:** The strategy of guessing an unknown word's meaning by analyzing the words and sentences *around* it (its context).
 - **Detailed Example:** Consider this difficult sentence: "The newly crowned king was known for his extreme **munificence**; he regularly distributed gold coins to the poor and funded the city's hospitals himself."
 - **The Clues:** The text says he "distributed gold" and "funded hospitals." This tells you **munificence** is related to being extremely *generous* or giving, even if you've never seen the word before.
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Topic 2: Formal Writing (Emails & Reports)

Goal: Being efficient. Professional writing is not literature; it's a tool for getting things done.

Busy people do not read; they **scan**. If your email is a long, dense wall of text, they will ignore it. Your goal is to deliver information quickly, clearly, and respect their time.

1. The Crucial Subject Line

This is your "**headline**." It determines if they open your email now, later, or delete it. A good subject line must be a specific summary.

- **Bad (Vague):** "Question"
- **Bad (Lazy):** "Homework"
- **Good (Action-Oriented):** "Question regarding Math Worksheet #4 (Due Tuesday)"
- **Good (Urgent):** "URGENT: Missing signature on field trip form"

2. The 7 Cs of Writing (Your Checklist)

Before you click 'send,' check your draft against this list:

The C	What it means	The Detailed Example
1. Clear	Use simple, unambiguous language.	Instead of: "We must utilize all available avenues..." Say: "We must use every option..."
2. Concise	Be brief. Remove unnecessary filler words.	Instead of: "Due to the fact that..." (4 words) Say: "Because..." (1 word)
3. Concrete	Use specific facts, data, and figures.	Instead of: "We need it soon."

The C	What it means	The Detailed Example
	Avoid "maybe" or "soon."	Say: "We need the finalized draft by Tuesday at 4 PM. "
4. Correct	Check spelling, grammar, and facts.	Example: Double-check that you spelled their name correctly and that "it's" (it is) vs. "its" (possessive) are used right.
5. Coherent	The logic must flow logically. The structure makes sense.	Example: Use bullet points for lists. Don't jump from Topic A to Topic C and then back to B. Use transition words ("However," "Therefore").
6. Complete	Include all necessary information and action items.	Example: If requesting a meeting, <i>include your availability.</i> (Don't just say, "Let's meet.")
7. Courteous	Be polite, positive, and respectful.	Example: Always include "Please," "Thank you," and a polite closing (e.g., "Best

The C	What it means	The Detailed Example
		regards,"). Avoid all-caps (which is SHOUTING!).

Topic 3: Verbal & Non-Verbal Skills

Goal: Ensuring your whole body sends the same message your voice does.

Communication is not just what you say. In fact, research (the famous Mehrabian study) suggests that feelings and attitudes are communicated:

- 7% through **Words** (the literal message)
- 38% through **Tone/Voice** (how you say it)
- 55% through **Body Language** (what you *look* like saying it)

If your words are polite but your body language is defensive, people will believe your body language every time.

1. Verbal (What you hear)

- **Word Choice:** Professional and simple (Topic 2).
- **Tone/Pitch:** The emotion behind the words.
- **Speed:** Speaking too fast shows nervousness. Speaking too slow shows boredom. A dynamic, varied speed is best.
- **Detailed Example (The importance of Tone):** Think about how many ways you can say the words, "That's just great."

- **Enthusiastic Tone:** You genuinely love it.
- **Sarcastic/Flat Tone:** You hate it, and you're annoyed. (The words didn't change, but the whole meaning did!)

2. Non-Verbal (What you see)

Your body communicates constantly. You cannot *not* communicate.

- **Facial Expressions:** The universal billboard.
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 - **Impact:** A genuine smile (with eye crinkles) builds rapport instantly. A continuous frown or scowl creates a psychological barrier.
 - **Gestures:** Hand movements used to emphasize points.
 - **Good:** Open-palm gestures (palms up/out) suggest openness, honesty, and confidence.
 - **Bad:** Overdoing it looks manic; pointing fingers looks aggressive.
 - **Posture:** The vertical alignment of your body.
 - **Power Posture:** Standing tall, shoulders back, head level. This screams "confidence."
 - **Weak Posture:** Slouching, crossed arms, looking down. This signals boredom, anxiety, or defensiveness (Image below).
 - **Eye Contact:** The most vital connection point.
 - **Impact:** Holding steady eye contact shows you are honest, paying attention, and confident. Avoiding eye contact makes you look nervous, disinterested, or untrustworthy.
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Topic 4: Active Listening

Goal: Hearing is physical; Listening is mental. Active listening means you are fully "in" the conversation.

Listening is not just 'waiting for your turn to talk.' It is a skill you must practice. Active listening requires you to focus 100% of your attention on the speaker and prove you are understanding them.

The Active Listening Cycle:

1. **Don't Interrupt (The Rule of Silence):** Let the speaker finish their *entire* thought before you respond. When they stop talking, wait one full second before you begin. People often add their most important point after a brief pause.
2. **Give Non-Verbal Feedback:** Prove you are present.
 - **Examples:** Nod your head. Maintain strong eye contact (Topic 3). Lean slightly forward toward the speaker. Use brief "minimal encouragers" like "I see," "Uh-huh," or "Right."
3. **Paraphrasing (The Echo):** Repeat back the *meaning* of what you heard, but in your *own* words. This is the ultimate test of understanding.
 - **Detailed Example:** A friend is frustrated and venting: "I've tried calling tech support three times today, they put me on hold for an hour, and then the call just drops! I'm so sick of this!"
 - **Your Active Response (Paraphrase):** "Wow, so you're incredibly frustrated because you've wasted your entire day dealing with terrible service that never gets fixed, right?" (This validates their *feelings* as well as the facts).
4. **Questioning (The Clarification):** Ask open-ended questions to gather more depth. These are questions that *cannot* be answered with a simple "yes" or "no." They usually start with **Why, How, or What**.

- **Bad Question:** "Did you like it?" (Response: "Yes.")
 - **Good Question:** "**What** part of it did you like the most?" (Requires detail).
 - **Good Question:** "**How** do you think we can fix this problem?"
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Topic 5: Public Speaking Basics

Goal: Mastering structure and anxiety through preparation.

Public speaking is a learned skill, not a natural talent. The greatest "secret" to confident speaking is thorough structure and preparation.

1. Preparation: Killing the Anxiety

Anxiety usually comes from a fear of the unknown.

- **Solution:** **Know your topic inside out.** If you are the expert on the topic, your anxiety plummets. Practice your speech out loud multiple times (not just in your head).

2. The Hook: Grabbing Attention in the First 10 Seconds

Do *not* start by saying, "Hello, my name is..." and stating your topic. You will lose them.

- **Start with:**
- **A Provocative Question:** "What is the one thing you would save if your house was on fire?"
- **A Shocking Statistic:** "Did you know that 90% of all data in the world was created in just the last two years?"
- **A Short Story:** A relevant 30-second personal anecdote.

3. The Power of Pauses (The Silent Weapon)

Many speakers are afraid of silence and rush to fill every second with "um" and "uh."

- **The Technique:** Silence is your friend. It sounds longer to you than to the audience. Pausing after a major point for **3 full seconds** creates gravity and lets the audience "digest" what you just said (Image below).

4. Eye Selection (Connecting, Not Staring)

Instead of nervously sweeping your eyes across the whole room or staring at your notes/the floor, use the "3-Person" technique:

- **The Technique:** Pick three friendly faces in the room: one on the left, one in the center, and one on the right. During your speech, rotate your eye contact between them. Make direct eye contact with one of them for 3–5 seconds (the length of a full thought or sentence) and then move to the next. The entire audience feels included when you make direct eye contact with people in each section.

Parent-Son Activity Idea:

The "Bad Email" Challenge (Applying Topic 2):

1. **Your Task:** Write the following "Bad Email" to your son. Make it as rude, vague, and messy as possible. (Copy and paste this into an email/text).

Subject: update

Hey, i need that stuff you said u wud do soon. idk why u always wait until last min lol. its annoying. tell me when u finish. also dont forget to bring that other thing too k cool thx.

2. **His Task:** Ask him to rewrite that email into a professional, clear, and polite message using **The 7 Cs** (Topic 2).

- **Spoiler (A 'Good' version):**

Subject: Request for Project Updates

Hi [Son's Name],

Could you please provide an update on the status of the science project you are working on? We need the final draft finalized by Tuesday at 4:00 PM.

Also, please remember to bring the signed permission slip for the field trip tomorrow.

Thank you,

[Parent's Name]

How would you like to proceed? Try the Bad Email challenge first, or move on to Unit 2: Self-Management notes next?